



AN ACT ESTABLISHING PRIORITIES FOR CULTURAL AND AESTHETIC PROJECTS GRANT AWARDS;  
APPROPRIATING MONEY FOR CULTURAL AND AESTHETIC GRANTS; AND PROVIDING AN EFFECTIVE  
DATE.

BE IT ENACTED BY THE LEGISLATURE OF THE STATE OF MONTANA:

**Section 1. Appropriation of cultural and aesthetic grant funds -- priority of disbursement. (1)**

The Montana arts council shall award grants for projects authorized by and limited to the amounts appropriated by [section 2] and this section.

(2) The Montana arts council shall disburse money to projects authorized by [section 2] through grant contracts between the Montana arts council and the grant recipient. The award contract with a grantee must require the grantee to post the following statement on its website, promotional materials, and publications: "Additional support from coal tax placed into Montana's Cultural and Aesthetic Projects Trust Fund." The award contract must bind the parties to conditions, if any, listed with the appropriation in [section 2].

(3) There is appropriated \$30,000 from the cultural and aesthetic projects trust fund account to the Montana historical society for the biennium ending June 30, 2027, for the care and conservation of capitol complex artwork.

**Section 2. Appropriation of cultural and aesthetic grant funds.** The following projects are approved, and \$953,500 is appropriated from the cultural and aesthetic projects trust fund account to the Montana arts council for the biennium ending June 30, 2027:

| Grant # | Grantee                       | Award Amount |
|---------|-------------------------------|--------------|
|         | Special Projects              |              |
| 2601    | Billings Preservation Society | \$12,500     |

|      |                                              |          |
|------|----------------------------------------------|----------|
| 2602 | Chickadee Community Services                 | \$20,160 |
| 2604 | Great Falls Public Library                   | \$19,660 |
| 2605 | International Choral Festival                | \$20,160 |
| 2606 | Mission Valley Live                          | \$0      |
| 2607 | Montana Jewish Project                       | \$20,160 |
| 2608 | The Extreme History Project                  | \$2,000  |
| 2609 | Working Quiet                                | \$20,160 |
|      | Operating Support                            |          |
| 2612 | Alpine Theatre Project                       | \$20,660 |
| 2613 | Archie Bray Foundation                       | \$19,660 |
| 2614 | Art Mobile of Montana                        | \$2,000  |
| 2615 | Arts Missoula                                | \$19,660 |
| 2616 | Bare Bait Dance                              | \$19,660 |
| 2619 | Bozeman Art Museum                           | \$2,000  |
| 2620 | Bozeman Symphony Society                     | \$19,660 |
| 2622 | C.M. Russell Museum                          | \$2,000  |
| 2623 | Carbon County Arts Guild & Depot Gallery     | \$20,660 |
| 2624 | Carbon County Historical Society             | \$20,660 |
| 2625 | Clay Studio of Missoula                      | \$19,660 |
| 2630 | Great Falls Symphony                         | \$19,660 |
| 2631 | Hamilton Players, Inc                        | \$20,160 |
| 2632 | Helena Symphony                              | \$2,000  |
| 2633 | Hockaday Museum of Art                       | \$19,660 |
| 2634 | Holter Museum of Art                         | \$19,660 |
| 2635 | Humanities Montana                           | \$20,160 |
| 2637 | MAGDA (Montana Art Gallery Directors Assoc.) | \$20,660 |
| 2638 | Mai Wah Society Museum                       | \$20,160 |
| 2639 | MAPS Media Institute                         | \$20,160 |

|      |                                            |          |
|------|--------------------------------------------|----------|
| 2640 | MCT, Inc.                                  | \$19,660 |
| 2641 | Missoula Art Museum                        | \$19,660 |
| 2642 | Missoula Symphony Association              | \$19,660 |
| 2643 | Missoula Writing Collaborative             | \$19,660 |
| 2644 | MonDak Heritage Center                     | \$20,660 |
| 2645 | Montana Association of Symphony Orchestras | \$20,660 |
| 2646 | Montana Ballet Company                     | \$19,660 |
| 2647 | Montana Dance Arts Association             | \$2,000  |
| 2648 | Montana Performing Arts Consortium         | \$20,660 |
| 2649 | Montana Playwrights Network                | \$20,160 |
| 2651 | Montana Shakespeare in the Parks           | \$19,660 |
| 2652 | Montana Youth Symphony                     | \$20,160 |
| 2653 | North Valley Music School                  | \$2,000  |
| 2655 | Paris Gibson Square Museum of Art          | \$19,660 |
| 2657 | Pondera Arts Council                       | \$2,000  |
| 2660 | Schoolhouse History & Art Center           | \$20,660 |
| 2661 | St. Timothy's Summer Music Festival        | \$12,160 |
| 2662 | Stillwater Historical Society              | \$20,660 |
| 2663 | Stumptown Art Studio                       | \$19,660 |
| 2664 | Sunburst Arts and Education                | \$20,660 |
| 2665 | The Myrna Loy                              | \$19,660 |
| 2666 | The Paradise Center                        | \$20,660 |
| 2667 | The Roxy Theater                           | \$19,660 |
| 2668 | Tinworks Art                               | \$19,660 |
| 2669 | Verge Theater                              | \$19,660 |
| 2670 | Western Heritage Center                    | \$12,500 |
| 2671 | Whitefish Review, Inc.                     | \$2,000  |
| 2672 | Whitefish Theatre Co.                      | \$2,000  |

|      |                                     |          |
|------|-------------------------------------|----------|
| 2673 | Zootown Arts Community Center       | \$19,660 |
|      | Capital Expenditures                |          |
| 2674 | Fort Peck Fine Arts Council, Inc.   | \$20,160 |
| 2675 | Red Lodge Area Community Foundation | \$20,160 |
| 2676 | Yellowstone Art Museum              | \$19,660 |

**Section 3. Reversion of grant money.** On July 1, 2027, the unencumbered balance of the grants for the biennium ending June 30, 2027, reverts to the cultural and aesthetic projects trust fund account provided for in 15-35-108.

**Section 4. Changes to grants on pro rata basis.** Except for the appropriation provided for in [section 1(3)], if money in the cultural and aesthetic projects trust fund account is insufficient to fund projects at the appropriation levels contained in [section 2], reductions to those projects with funding greater than \$2,000 must be made on a pro rata basis.

**Section 5. Effective date.** [This act] is effective July 1, 2025.

- END -

I hereby certify that the within bill,  
HB 9, originated in the House.

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Chief Clerk of the House

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Speaker of the House

Signed this \_\_\_\_\_ day  
of \_\_\_\_\_, 2025.

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President of the Senate

Signed this \_\_\_\_\_ day  
of \_\_\_\_\_, 2025.

HOUSE BILL NO. 9

INTRODUCED BY J. FITZPATRICK

BY REQUEST OF THE OFFICE OF BUDGET AND PROGRAM PLANNING

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